ture and decor. In this way, technology can be an enabler to help us serve the customer better.

Today, technology has helped us distill insights faster, compared to a few years ago, when our systems were more analog. Earlier, teams operated more on intuition and experience whereas today we can operate on insights at scale. It is about the 'art of the possible,' not the art of the impossible.

Amethyst, our AI platform, has allowed us to experiment in a safe and closed environment. We believe experimentation must be disciplined and that we must institutionalise learnings in situations where we may not have been successful in our pursuit. I strongly believe that good ideas can come from anywhere in the organisation and that we must create a culture where everyone feels like their ideas are appreciated and valued. A lot of our innovation programmes and digital enablement are based on active learning projects which are implemented in the businesses.



Cross functional teams come together from across the organisation, and what I find interesting about this approach is that diversity of perspectives help each of us to question our own assumptions and biases and come to a better and more holistic outcome.

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Are you doing a lot of that today?

Yes, and our diversity of businesses becomes a strength if one can do cross-learnings between them. For example, material exploration and aerospace can have some value for appliance components. In my view, cross-deployment, whether it's on the shopfloor or on go-to-market or the product, is where our strength is.

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How has the process of picking a new business foray changed or matured over time?

I'll take two examples. One can be around an adjacency. In our locks business, for instance, we have a very strong distribution network for mechanical and digital looks. We looked at how this channel synergy can help us enter a new business.

We looked at this whole idea of architectural hardware that goes through the same channel. It's a different product and it made sense to bring it through an adjacency through some synergy in terms of channel or customer.

There are many bets we have taken. Today, storage of energy is an area where we have put innovation money. So, we have incubated a business of battery chemistry that is more earth abundant.

This is not for consumer electronics but more for large-scale industrial energy use cases.

Here, blue-sky thinking is around what the needs of the country will be when we are thinking of moving towards Viksit Bharat. We can, in some sense, provide capability, expertise and patient capital to bring it to market. BT

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